

- **There will be 20 professional skills marks out of 100 covering following professional skills:**
 - Communication
 - Analysis and evaluation
 - Scepticism
 - Commercial Acumen
- **Distribution:**
 - **Section A:**
 - All four professional skills will be examined
 - The 50 marks will comprise of 40 technical marks and 10 professional skills marks
 - **Section B:**
 - Each question will contain a minimum of two professional skills from:
 - Analysis and evaluation
 - Scepticism
 - Commercial Acumen
 - The 25 marks will comprise of 20 technical marks and 5 professional skills marks
- **How Professional skills are assessed:**
 - **Communication:**
 - The style of communication should always be determined by intended audience:
 - Client
 - Supplier
 - Senior management
 - The style includes:
 - Tone
 - Familiarity
 - Level of detail included
 - Use appropriate format
 - Inform audience in clear and persuasive manner
 - Section A will ask for a report. This report should have:
 - Introduction
 - Appropriate headings and sub-headings
 - Calculations should be separated off into an appendix in the spreadsheet response area
 - Make use of spreadsheet functionality
 - Conclusion
 - Adherence to any specific instructions in the given scenario
 - Points must be logical and progressive
 - Avoid repetition

- **Analysis and evaluation:**
 - It is logical interpretation of information and then processing it systematically
 - Evaluation should always follow any analysis that have been performed
 - Identifying where data appears to be omitted or where further analysis is needed to make a recommendation is also important
 - Estimating future trends and making sensible forecasts of the implications of decisions which the organisation is making
 - Ask questions such as:
 - What do the final calculations suggest?
 - Are there any financial factors not included in the calculations which could be relevant for decision making?
 - Are there any significant non-financial factors that need to be considered?
 - Marks are awarded for sensible analysis supported by relevant calculations
 - Think of following areas while evaluating a proposal:
 - What information is available in the scenario?
 - Use numerical information provided to perform calculations to form the basis of your analysis
 - What information actually means and its impact on the organisation
 - Cover both advantages and disadvantages
 - Conclude or recommend
- **Scepticism:**
 - Have a questioning approach
 - To demonstrate effective scepticism, show a combination of:
 - Probing
 - Questioning
 - Challenge within the subject matter
 - Do the projections given seem realistic?
 - Possibility of over-optimism in figures
 - Don't accuse about bias as this approach will lack professionalism
 - Appropriate to recognise possibility of bias or self-interest
 - Challenge view diplomatically rather than directly
 - Also, don't consider that everything provided in the question is incorrect
- **Commercial acumen:**
 - Show awareness of both the internal and external environments which can affect the organisation, including any constraints and opportunities
 - Business awareness
 - Consider validity and reasonableness of any assumptions made
 - Consider the nature and size of the entity under consideration and whether the suggestion being provided is appropriate for the business